

Topic 3.3

3.3: Message Passing Paradigm

Some OOPLs, notably Smalltalk, use a message passing paradigm. C++ does not really adhere to this paradigm, but it can be useful to think in terms of it. If we consider the previous Account class and the following code fragment:

```
Account acct;  
acct.deposit(1000);
```

the message passing paradigm would explain this as follows. The object `acct` is passed a message `deposit`, instructing it to `deposit` an amount to itself. The amount to deposit, \$1,000 in this case, is passed as a parameter of the message.

In such language, we often talk about the functions/procedures that manipulate objects as methods. Formally, C++ does not use this terminology. However, you may hear member functions informally referred to as methods.

Topic 3.4 (<https://onlinelearning.berkeley.edu/courses/2291660/pages/topic-3-dot-4>)